

Arts

With its emphasis on research and innovation, Lady Shri Ram College takes the lead as long-time leader Loyola College, Chennai, drops a spot while Miranda House makes its entry into the Top 10

TOP 10 COLLEGES

	2010	2009	2008
^	1 Lady Shri Ram College for Women, Delhi	2	5
✓	2 Loyola College, Chennai	1	1
>>	3 St. Stephen's College, Delhi	3	3
>>	4 St. Xavier's College, Mumbai	4	2
>>	5 St. Xavier's College, Kolkata	5	9
^	6 Presidency College, Kolkata	7	4
^	7 Fergusson College, Pune	10	7
✓	8 Christ College, Bangalore	5	6
>>	9 Stella Maris College, Chennai	9	10
★	10 Miranda House, Delhi	11	12

National rankings are derived from a combination of perceptual and factual scores.
Colleges that did not provide factual information were not ranked.
Faculties were not considered. ★ New entrant in Top 10.

INSIGHT

Meenakshi Gopinath, Principal, LSR, Delhi

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By Diksha Madhok

The role of education is not just to equip students with a skill or a degree, but also to enable the youth to engage with new ideas and interrogate stereotypes. The best arts colleges in the country have succeeded in providing just the right environment for innovation to its students. Lady Shri Ram College (LSR), which has emerged as the best institution in the country for arts and humanities, has been a centre of excellence and achievement for more than five decades now. LSR's ideology, since its inception, has been to help women break cultural and economic barriers. Achievement for LSR graduates is not just about climbing the corporate ladder, but also about attaining sophistication of mind, and its distinguished alumni are a glowing testimony to the college's commitment to this goal.

The college boasts of the highest number of first divisions in Delhi University. Every year it receives nearly 22,000 applications from which only 700 are selected. It also actively encourages exchange programmes with foreign universities and receives a large number of requests from prospective students overseas.

One of the most distinguishing features about LSR is its emphasis on research. "I think research potential is grossly undervalued at the undergraduate level in the Indian higher education setup. But LSR believes that it is a highly energetic space and we do everything possible to encourage our students to innovate and think out of the box," says Meenakshi Gopinath, principal, LSR. From this year onward, the college will make grants available to foster collaborative research projects between the faculty and the students. The college also plans to develop a full-fledged research and training centre on conflict transformation and peace building. At present, it offers a diploma in the subject.

Some of LSR's other future projects include scaling up its journalism programme and converting it into a media communication course. In 2012, the college plans to launch a management programme, which promises to be different from run of the mill MBA courses. "We aim to develop a new vocabulary for management. Many of our women are in top management positions and we plan to draw in that expertise," explains Gopinath.

This year, Fergusson College, Pune, ascended from the tenth position to the seventh, whereas Christ College